TENSORFORGE 2.0 · FINAL-FORGE

Final Round

by ascentic

Student Rules & Guidelines Booklet

Key Dates & Timings

Final day: 17 October 2026. You have a **6-hour build window (8:00 am - 2.00pm)**, starting from an **empty repository**.

First 30 minutes: submit your one-line problem statement to the organizing committee.

Deadline: judges review your **last commit before the deadline**. Late submissions are not accepted. The submission channel is announced on the day.

1. Overview

All eight finalist teams build and document an **ML-powered product** in six hours, then pitch it live (8 minutes pitching time + 5 minutes QA). The rules in Section 4 are **binding**; the plan and tips in Sections 5 to 7 are **advice**.

2. The Theme: Scam-Proof by Design

"Ship AI that catches deception today and notices when the scammers change tactics tomorrow."

Build a product that protects people in Sri Lanka from fraud, impersonation or synthetic deception in your assigned domain. You choose the niche and the problem; the theme sets the direction. Both halves count:

- **Detection:** your product must catch something real, such as a scam message, a fake claim or an impersonation attempt.
- **Staying power:** scams change quickly, so your product must notice when the patterns it sees start to shift, and respond before it quietly fails.

Why this theme now

In June 2026 the Central Bank of Sri Lanka launched a nationwide "Be Scam Proof" campaign, warning that digital fraud is becoming more sophisticated and adaptive. A model that is accurate on launch day can fail weeks later without anyone noticing, so scam detection is a production problem, not a one-off accuracy contest. New public systems, such as the planned national digital ID (SL-UDI), also create new targets for impersonation.

What a strong solution shows

1. **Real detection.** An ML component does the core work, with honest results on a held-out test set.
2. **It runs like a product.** A working service that someone else can start from your repository or a live deployment, with logging and documented setup.
3. **It notices drift.** You create a shifted version of your data and your system raises a signal when it sees it.
4. **It responds.** An alert, safe fallback, human-review route or retraining trigger, so the product does not fail silently.
5. **It matters to someone.** A clear account of who is protected, how many people you could reach and what harm you prevent.

Model accuracy alone will not win. Judges weight deployment, monitoring and drift response more heavily than raw model performance. Your **social-impact case** also carries explicit weight: show who is protected (for example first-time mobile-banking users, rural pensioners or welfare recipients), how many you could reach, and a realistic path to a pilot or public tool.

3. Data at a Glance

No dataset or benchmark is provided. Source or generate your own during the build window, and create your own shifted data (new scam wording, a new language mix or a new impersonation target) to demonstrate drift. Full rules are in Rule 2.

4. Rules (Binding)

Rule 1: Teams, domains and problem selection

1. You choose your own niche and problem within your preferred domain and the Scam-Proof by Design theme.
2. Submit a **one-line problem statement** within the **first 30 minutes**. Changing it later needs committee approval.
3. The solution must serve users or institutions in **Sri Lanka**, though it may use global data and methods.

Rule 2: Data and privacy

1. Source or generate your own data within the build window. Public datasets may be downloaded on the day.
2. Allowed sources: **public datasets whose licence permits this use**, **synthetic data** you generate (including with LLMs), and **examples you write by hand**.
3. List every data source in the README with its licence or generation method.
4. **No real personal data**: no real phone numbers, NIC numbers, bank details or screenshots of identifiable people's messages. Follow the principles of Sri Lanka's Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022.
5. No private, leaked or scraped data from closed groups and chats.
6. Synthetic scam messages and documents are for training and testing only. **Never send them** to real phone numbers, emails or accounts, and never post them publicly.
7. Keep a **held-out test set** and a separate **shifted set** for the drift demo, and describe both in the README

Rule 3: Code, models and tools

1. All project code is written **during the 6-hour window from an empty repository**. Judges review the commit history, so **commit regularly**; a single large commit at the end may be questioned.
2. Open-source libraries, pretrained and open-weight models, public model hubs, cloud services and LLM APIs are allowed. Use your own accounts and keys; no credits are provided.
3. Personal templates (such as a Dockerfile or project scaffold) may be reused if **declared in the README**.
4. AI coding assistants are allowed. **Declare the tools used**, and every member must be able to explain the code in the viva.
5. You need a **real ML component doing core work**: a trained or fine-tuned classifier, an embedding-based detector, or an LLM pipeline with its own evaluation. A product that only forwards input to a third-party chatbot, with no evaluation or monitoring, does not meet this rule.
6. As previously announced, have your own backup internet connection. A network outage does not extend the build window unless the committee announces a venue-wide extension.

Rule 4: Minimum requirements and deliverables

A missing item costs marks in the related judging criterion. Every solution must show:

Requirement	What judges expect
Running service	API or app, shown in a **live demo**, started from documented commands (a container is preferred).
Reproducible pipeline	Data preparation, training or adaptation, and evaluation scripts in the repo, with **pinned dependencies**.
Evaluation results	Results on your **held-out test set**, reported in the README.
Monitoring	**Prediction logging** plus at least one **drift signal** (input distribution shift, falling confidence or a rising share of unknown inputs), demonstrated on the shifted set.
Drift response	An alert, safe fallback, human-review route or retraining trigger, demonstrated or clearly documented.

At the end of the build window, submit through the channel announced on the day:

#	Item	Details
1	Repository link	Public, or shared with the judges.
2	README	Problem and users, data sources and licences, **architecture diagram**, how to run it, evaluation results, how monitoring and drift response work, and AI tools used.
3	Impact statement	At most **one page** (README section or separate file): who is protected, how many people could be reached, measurable harm prevented, and a realistic path to adoption.
4	Pitch deck	Submitted as a **PDF**.

Judges review the last commit before the deadline. Late submissions are not accepted unless the committee grants an extension for a venue-wide problem.

Rule 5: Conduct, safety and integrity

1. Teams work **independently**. Code, data and models may not be shared between teams.
2. Only **registered team members** contribute during the build window. No remote help from anyone else.
3. Mentors and organizers can clarify rules and help with venue or technical access issues, but **do not help build solutions**.
4. Reusing someone else's project or code without attribution is plagiarism.
5. Build responsibly: **no tools that generate or send scams to real people**, and **no look-alike pages of real organizations**. Demos that mention real banks or agencies must use clearly labelled synthetic examples.
6. Follow KDU's campus rules and the instructions of organizers and security staff. The IEEE Code of Conduct applies; harassment or disrespect towards anyone leads to removal from the event.

Rule 6: Intellectual property, disqualification and disputes

1. Teams own what they build. By competing, finalists agree to publish their repository under an **open licence** of their choice (such as MIT or Apache-2.0).
2. Repositories must **not contain secrets** such as API keys or passwords.
3. Organizers may share team names, project descriptions, photos and demo recordings to promote the event.
4. A team may be **disqualified** for: work done before the build window or by non-members, using real personal data, plagiarism, sending scam content to real people, tampering with another team's work, or serious misconduct.

5. Suggested Plan for the 6 Hours

This is advice, not a rule. Teams that leave deployment and monitoring to the last hour usually run out of time, so build the pipeline early and improve the model inside it.

Time	Stage	Focus
0:00 – 0:30	Frame it	Pick the niche, name the users you protect, write the one-line problem statement, agree who does what.
0:30 – 1:30	Data	Gather or generate training data and the held-out test set; draft the shifted set for the drift demo.
1:30 – 2:30	First working pipeline	Simple baseline model behind a running API or app, prediction logging on. **Commit it.**
2:30 – 3:30	Improve the model	Better features or models, honest evaluation, handling of Sinhala, Tamil and mixed text if relevant.
3:30 – 4:30	Monitoring and drift	Run the shifted set, show the drift signal firing, wire up the response (alert, fallback, human review or retraining).
4:30 – 5:30	Package it	Container or run script, pinned dependencies, README, architecture diagram, impact statement.

Time	Stage	Focus
5:30 – 6:00	Rehearse and submit	Practice the 8-minute pitch and live demo, prepare a backup recording, **and submit before the deadline**.

6. Structuring the 8-Minute Pitch

Section	Time	What to cover
The problem	1 min	Who gets scammed, how, and why it matters in Sri Lanka now.
Your solution	1 min	What the product does and who uses it.
Live demo	2 – 3 min	A real input through the running system, then the shifted data triggering the drift signal and the response.
How it is built	1 – 2 min	Architecture, data sources, evaluation results and the MLOps setup.
Impact and next steps	1 min	Who is protected, how many people you could reach, harm prevented, path to a pilot.

Viva: judges may ask **any member** about **any part** of the solution. Make sure everyone can explain the data, the model, the deployment and the drift response.

7. Submission Checklist

- ☐ One-line problem statement submitted in the first 30 minutes
- ☐ Repository link shared (public or with the judges)
- ☐ Service starts from documented commands (container or run script)
- ☐ Data sources and licences listed; no real personal data
- ☐ Held-out test results reported in the README
- ☐ Shifted set created and drift signal demonstrated
- ☐ Drift response shown or documented
- ☐ README complete, with architecture diagram and AI tools used
- ☐ Impact statement (one page)
- ☐ Pitch deck as a PDF
- ☐ No API keys or passwords in the repository
- ☐ Final commit made before the deadline

Sources

- CBSL launches “Be Scam Proof” initiative as digital fraud, illegal investment schemes rise, Daily FT, June 2026
- Sri Lanka digital ID rollout advances as procurement nears completion, Biometric Update, August 2026

Good luck, finalists. Build it scam-proof.